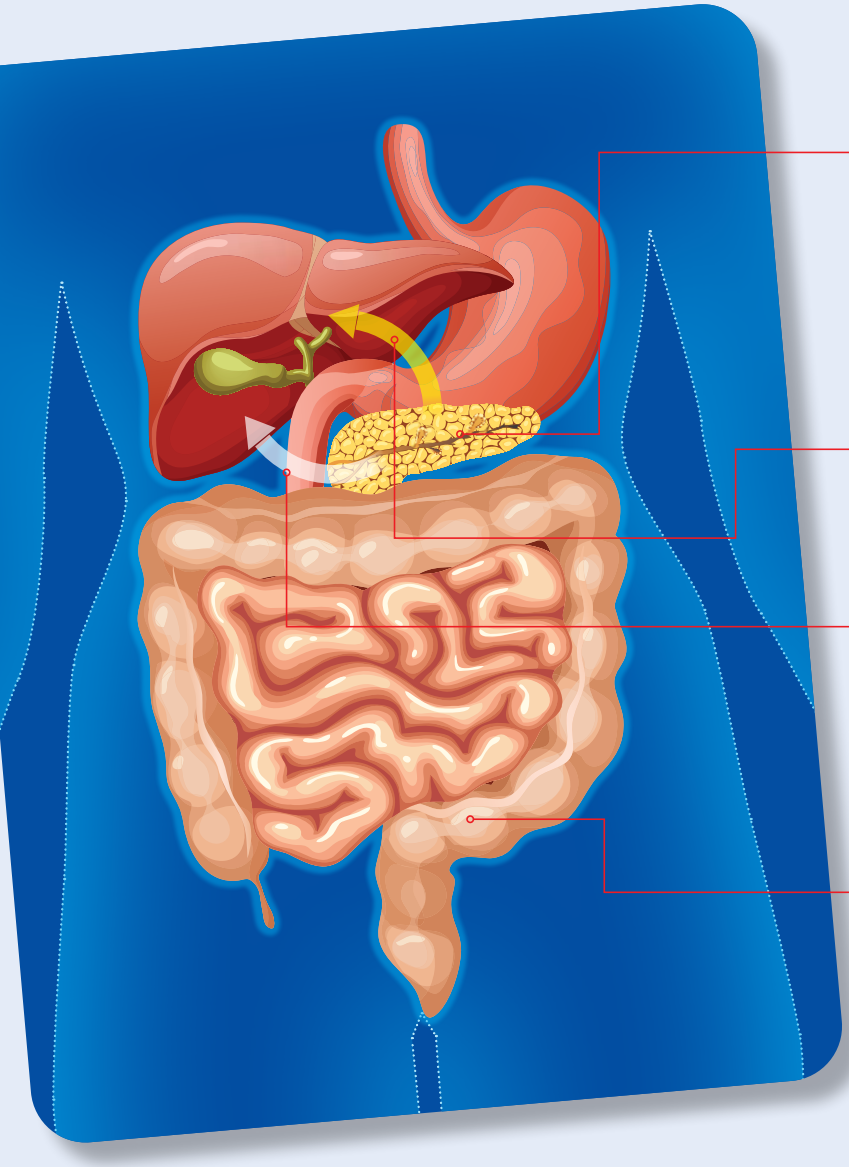
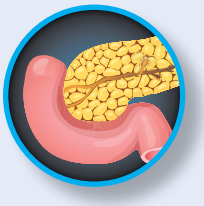
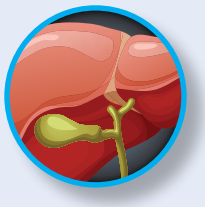


## HOW DOES IT WORK?

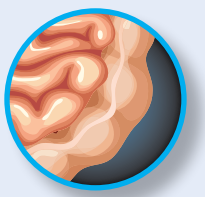


**Activates GLP-1 receptors:** The GLP-1 agonist binds itself to the receptors of the hormone called glucagon-like peptide, found in the pancreas and some neurons in the brain, activating them when food is ingested

**Helps release insulin:** Their activation coaxes the pancreas to produce more insulin, the hormone that transports glucose from food into our cells for energy



**Suppresses glucagon:** Semaglutide also reduces the release of glucagon, another hormone found in the alpha cells of the pancreas, which raises blood sugar levels by promoting glucose release from the liver



**Slows digestion:** Semaglutide also slows down the pace at which food moves in our digestive tract. This not only helps improve absorption of nutrients and glucose but also gives the body a feeling of fullness, preventing unnecessary eating

*Graphic by* TANMOY CHAKRABORTY



**JAYASEELAN J.**
*Vice President, Indian Pharmaceutical Association*

**"20 YEARS AGO, THE WORLD WAS RUNNING AFTER PROZAC. TODAY, IT IS SEMAGLUTIDE. IT CERTAINLY HAS MANY MERITS, BUT SO STRONG HAS BEEN ITS MARKETING THAT IT'S BEING SEEN AS A MAGIC PILL TO ALL OUR HEALTH CONCERNS"**

the pill began to be offered individually or alongside metformin, the traditional choice of medication so far. It was especially useful for obese and overweight diabetics, because it also helped in weight loss, something the other two diabetic treatments—metformin and insulin—couldn't do. Metformin had no effect on a person's weight, and insulin has weight-gaining properties, according to some doctors.

However, it was in the very blessing of semaglutide that its bane started emerging. In a body image-obsessed world, the drug began to be used more for vanity weight loss, by people who were neither diabetic nor overweight. "It began to be seen as a blockbuster agent for weight loss by people